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Samsung Galaxy S10

Just as good as the bigger Galaxy S10+

The Samsung Galaxy S10 series was announced earlier this month in three largely similar versions: the S10, S10+, and S10e. We've reviewed the S10 that follows between the S10+ and S10e.

Build and Design

The Samsung Galaxy S10 looks and feels like a flagship smartphone. What's more, it's IP68 rated for dust and water resistance. Its glass construction and overall curvy design make you feel you're holding the right sort of mobile phone in a meeting or at an airport. Users who prefer one-handed use of their smartphones will appreciate the Galaxy S10's size. We were able to use the Galaxy S10 in one hand comfortably while browsing and typing.

Display and Audio

The Galaxy S10's display is supremely bright, colourful, and a treat to look at, whether you're using the phone for casual browsing or playing a rich HDR10+ enabled video. Some apps and games, like YouTube, Asphalt 9 draw right over the selfie camera on the upper right corner without any problems to fit the entire screen, while others like Amazon Prime Video and Ace Force don't use the area above the selfie camera. The single side-firing loudspeaker on the Galaxy S10 is crisp and loud for both calls and music. The earpiece, on the other hand, could have been a little louder for voice calls. But that's not something major to complain about.



Performance and Gaming

The Samsung Galaxy S10 performs the way a flagship smartphone should: it runs multiple heavy apps simultaneously without any signs of sweat or delay. Gaming performance on the Galaxy S10 seems right up there too. Despite the drop in benchmark score, it's hard to call the Galaxy S10 a bad gaming device as I noticed no visible stutters or lags in the review unit.

Ultrasonic Fingerprint Scanner and Face Unlock

On average, we found the fingerprint scanner successful in matching six times out of ten, that too after taking a whole second to read the fingerprint usually. This, along with the well-functioning face unlock, can be used with Samsung Pay and other apps that support it.

Software

The Samsung Galaxy S10 runs Android 9 Pie with Samsung's new One UI thrown on top of it. Fans of the old TouchWiz UI will come to like the new UI as it looks cleaner in some areas, like the app drawer and menus while retaining that familiar Samsung feel to the icons and menu items. Apart from that easily recognisable Samsung look, the UI on Android 9 Pie comes with Samsung's proprietary gesture-based navigation. Overall, it's a good software experience,

Price
₹66,900



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Camera

The Samsung Galaxy S10's camera is ideal for most conditions even though low-light conditions invite a noticeable amount of pixelation and noise in the photos. The wide-angle camera displayed a considerable amount of barrel distortion. The front camera photos appeared fine but a little less colourful, and eager to "beautify" faces even when the level was set to minimum.

Battery

If you're a medium to heavy user of your phone, you can expect the Samsung Galaxy S10 to last you a little over a day on a single charge of the 3400mAh battery. Juicing the handset to 100 percent takes 90 minutes.

Bottom Line

If you're looking for a flagship smartphone that scores high on performance, photography, and aesthetics, the Samsung Galaxy S10 is perfect for you. However, given the fact that the larger Galaxy S10+ is only Rs 7,000 away, why would you pick the Galaxy S10 up? You'd pick the Galaxy S10 over the S10+ only because you don't care too much about selfies, you want a slightly more compact body, you don't need 0.3 inches more of screen space, and you don't mind trading in battery capacity for a cheaper flagship.

While the battery performance on the Samsung Galaxy S10 can be termed good, the battery performance on the Galaxy S10+ is superior. If the extra bucks don't matter to you, you're better off getting the Galaxy S10+. If, however, you want a slightly more compact Samsung flagship smartphone, the Galaxy S10 is just as good. In summary, whether it's the Samsung Galaxy S10 or S10+, you really can't go wrong with one of the two.

—Vignesh Giridharan

SPECIFICATIONS

PROCESSOR: Exynos 9820 | RAM: 8GB LPDDR4x | DISPLAY SIZE: 6.1 inches | DISPLAY RESOLUTION: 3040 X 1440 | HDR SUPPORT: HDR10+ | IP RATING: IP68 | BATTERY CAPACITY: 3400mAh

CONTACT

SAMSUNG INDIA | WEBSITE: samsung.com/in | PHONE: 1800-40-7267864 | EMAIL: Web Form